Sahiba Chopra

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Education

University of California, Berkeley, Haas School of Business — Expected 2027
PhD Candidate in Management Science

University of California, Berkeley
Master of Science in Business Administration

University of San Francisco
Master of Science in Applied Economics

University of Maryland, College Park
Bachelor of Arts in Economics and Mandarin Chinese (double major)
Huayu Enrichment Scholarship, Ministry of Education, Taiwan; Economics Department Service Award

Job Market Paper

Not Worth the Effort: Generative AI and Effort Opacity in Collaborative Work

Generative AI helps individuals produce more, and sometimes better, work, yet realizing its value often depends on the engagement it attracts from others. This paper examines one form of engagement in collaborative work: the effort collaborators invest in reviewing and developing one another's contributions. Because creator effort is rarely observable, reviewers infer it from the work before deciding how much review effort to reciprocate. I argue that AI creates *effort opacity* by making the traces of effort in work less informative, leading reviewers to reciprocate less through review. Departing from questions about whether AI-assisted work is judged favorably, this paper asks whether AI-assisted work can attract the review effort it needs to be developed. Using a custom AI classifier on code from top GitHub projects with over 1 million stars and 2 million downstream dependencies, I find that AI-assisted work receives 25% less detailed feedback and is 30 percentage points more likely to be rejected, even after controlling for code quality. A pre-registered study with software developers tests the effort opacity mechanism. Holding the underlying code constant, I vary AI disclosure and visible evidence of contributor effort. Making substantial creator effort legible increases review priority even when AI assistance is disclosed. Perceived contributor effort is the only measured mediator with a statistically significant indirect effect. These findings show that by making effort harder to infer from the work itself, technology can reduce the reciprocal review needed to develop and integrate valuable work.

Paper Under Review

Which Ideas Attract Workers? Gender and Labor Supply in Startups
Solène Delecourt (UC Berkeley Haas), Katelyn Cranney (Stanford), **Sahiba Chopra**, and Rembrand Koning (Harvard Business School)
Revise and resubmit, *Management Science*

- Best Conference Paper Award nominee, Strategic Management Society Annual Conference (2023)
- Research Methods Paper Prize nominee, Strategic Management Society Annual Conference (2023)

Related Publication

The Fabricated Front: Generative AI and the Opacity of Workplace Performance
Tom van Nuenen (UC Berkeley D-Lab), Pratik S. Sachdeva (UC Berkeley D-Lab), and **Sahiba Chopra**
Forthcoming, *The Paris Journal on AI & Digital Ethics.*
Extends effort opacity from collaborative review to workplace-performance evaluation.

Pre-Doctoral Publication

Chopra, S., & Wydick, B. (2024). The health costs of political identity: Evidence from the U.S. during the COVID-19 pandemic. *Politics, Groups, and Identities, 12*(5), 1093–1117.

Work in Progress

Whose Transparency Is It Anyway?
Genevieve Smith (BAIR, UC Berkeley), **Sahiba Chopra**, Natalia Luka (BAIR, UC Berkeley), and Min Kyung Lee (UT Austin)
Preparing for submission.

The Technical Debt Tradeoff: Generative AI, Shipping Speed, and the Future Cost of Work
Sahiba Chopra and Dhruv Agarwal (Middleware HQ)
Data and analysis underway.

From AI Tools to AI Systems: How Organizations Redesign Work Around Generative AI
Sahiba Chopra, Calista Cooper (Vendasta), Kim Coutts (Vendasta), and Mathijs de Vaan (UC Berkeley)
Fieldwork underway.

Grants

Institute for Business Innovation Research Grant, UC Berkeley ($2,600)	2026
Institute for Business Innovation Research Grant, UC Berkeley ($5,000)	2025
Institute for Business Innovation Research Grant, UC Berkeley ($5,000)	2024
Department Grant for Dissertation Work, UC Berkeley ($3,000)	2024
Center for Equity, Gender & Leadership Research Grant, UC Berkeley ($5,000)	2021

Honors

Data Science and AI Fellow, UC Berkeley D-Lab (competitively selected)
Huayu Enrichment Scholarship, Ministry of Education, Taiwan
Economics Department Service Award, University of Maryland

Presentations

(* = upcoming)

2026: Strategic Management Society Annual Conference*; Uber Science Jam; University of San Francisco, Department of Economics; Academy of Management Annual Meeting; Wharton AI and the Future of Work Conference (poster); Bay Area Behavioral and Experimental Economics Conference; AI Plus Management Doctoral Consortium; Bay Area Management PhD Conference; University of California Open Summit; All Tech Is Human × Mastercard AI Governance Workshop

2025: Academy of Management Annual Meeting; Duke Strategy Conference

2020 (pre-doctoral): NABE TEC Conference

Teaching

UC Berkeley Haas School of Business 2023–2025
Graduate Student Instructor, Leading People (MBA and Executive MBA) *Berkeley, CA*

- Served across four MBA and Executive MBA offerings enrolling approximately 600 students; calibrated grading standards, assessed assignments and exams, provided individualized feedback, and helped students apply course concepts to workplace problems.
- Managed course communications and learning infrastructure; monitored participation; developed decision-making surveys that remain in use; repeatedly invited to return as GSI.

UC Berkeley D-Lab 2024–2025
Data Science and AI Fellow (competitively selected) *Berkeley, CA*
Led twelve workshops in Python, R data visualization, and Git for approximately 120 learners ranging from undergraduates to faculty; provided continued one-to-one support to approximately ten participants.

Packt Publishing 2019
Instructor *Online*
Developed and taught online courses on machine-learning methods, including *Hands-On Feature Engineering in Python* and *Scikit-Learn Recipes*.

Mentoring and Service

Academy of Management Annual Meeting: Co-organizer, "Beyond Productivity: Designing Research on AI Adoption, Evaluation, and Training" PDW (2026); ad hoc reviewer (2026); organizer, panel symposium on generative AI and organizations (2025).

UC Berkeley Haas: Organizer, PhD Community Social Programming (2024–2025); organizer, PhD Admissions Visit Weekend (2023).

Founder and Mentor, Women Who Code Mumbai. Mentored women learning to code and navigating careers in technology (2017–2018).

Industry Experience

Happy Loans 2018–2019
Lead Data Scientist *Mumbai, India*
Built credit-risk models supporting US$2 million in lending, reducing the default rate by 2 percentage points while increasing the approval rate by 10 percentage points.

SugarBox 2017–2018
Data Scientist *Mumbai, India*
Built infrastructure for 20 TB of daily usage data and a recommendation system for 20,000 users that increased time spent in the mobile app by 80%.

Mahindra Susten 2015–2017
Data Scientist *Mumbai, India*
Developed renewable-energy forecasting and fault-detection models that generated US$1 million in savings and led to a US$500,000 analytics-services contract.

Methods

Field and online experiments; causal inference; machine learning; computational text analysis; Python; R; Stata; Git

Languages

English (native); Hindi (native); Punjabi (intermediate); Mandarin Chinese (basic); Spanish (beginner)

References

Mathijs de Vaan
Associate Professor, UC Berkeley Haas

Abhishek Nagaraj
Associate Professor, UC Berkeley Haas

Solène Delecourt
Assistant Professor, UC Berkeley Haas

Don Moore
Professor and Lorraine Tyson Mitchell Chair in Leadership and Communication, UC Berkeley Haas